operations; deployments; data processing engines; and pipelines. All that needs to be scalable to serve business needs as they arise.

- *Resilience*—Smooth operation of data-driven businesses requires high availability of data. Therefore, the infrastructure should ensure redundancies and disaster-recovery protocols at the design level of each infrastructural element.
- *Process automation*—From injecting metadata at the data product registry to ensuring access control, the data flow through the central infrastructure needs to be fully automated—possibly using machine learning (ML) and artificial intelligence (AI) to ensure efficient data processing, quality, and monitoring.

Now that you have a short summary of the four key data mesh principles, let's revisit Candace and see how she scores on these principles.

1.5 Back to snow shoveling

In Candace's business, you might identify a few *expert domains*. Seems like shovel procurement is one, but the two streets also seem to be separate domains. They definitely are different in some key elements, and local knowledge is needed to work effectively. Let's look at how the business has evolved over time:

- In Candace's first year, her team does not own the data even though they own their *domains* in the sense that they are responsible for operations there as well as creating domain data. There is no data governance mentioned and not much of a platform to help them do anything with data. Data is a by-product of their work.
- In Candace's second year, she makes a key change. She gives Adam and Eve data ownership in their domains. She also extends their responsibilities in general, and this is something that happens in many companies before transferring data ownership. However, there is still no data governance or platform, and not much data is being treated as a product.